

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Cyber Defence | SOC Operations | SIEM

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations, incident response and cyber defence, with deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, alert triage and threat analysis across complex enterprise environments. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I lead security monitoring, incident response and threat hunting across an 8,000-user hybrid environment, operating CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel and the full Microsoft Defender suite as core cyber defence platforms. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, NIST 800-61-aligned approach to incident response, managing full case lifecycle from initial detection and alert triage through containment, eradication and recovery, with a proven track record of expanding internal cyber defence capability and measurably improving mean time to respond (MTTR) in enterprise environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, end-to-end case management, containment, eradication and recovery, post-incident review
- **SIEM and Alert Triage:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language), alert investigation and triaging
- **Threat Analysis and Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, MITRE ATT&CK framework, indicators of compromise (IoC) analysis, advanced threat hunting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Cyber Defence Operations:** Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), Mimecast email security, network traffic analysis, log analysis
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Automated playbook development, triage automation, mean time to respond (MTTR) reduction
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Scripting:** PowerShell
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Expand and strengthen the internal cyber defence capability across an 8,000-user hybrid enterprise environment, leading Security Operations Centre (SOC) monitoring, alert triage and incident response functions
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel as primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, triaging and investigating security alerts across cloud and on-premise infrastructure in real time
- Lead end-to-end incident response in accordance with the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, managing full case ownership from initial detection and containment through eradication, recovery and post-incident review

- Conduct in-depth threat analysis using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, correlating indicators of compromise (IoCs) with the MITRE ATT&CK framework to determine incident scope, threat actor tactics and impact
- Lead proactive threat hunting operations, identifying advanced persistent threats (APTs) and anomalous activity ahead of automated detection thresholds
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, automating repetitive triage tasks to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) and free analyst capacity for high-complexity investigations
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), maintaining comprehensive coverage across the cyber defence stack
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing access controls and reducing privileged account risk
- Drive vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus and Pentera BAS, identifying and prioritising remediation of exploitable weaknesses across the estate
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall and Mimecast email security platform, maintaining perimeter and messaging layer cyber defences

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored security alerts across SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and email security platforms, triaging incidents and managing response activities in line with NIST 800-61 procedures
- Conducted threat analysis of security events, correlating log data and alert context to determine incident classification, scope and appropriate response actions
- Assisted in building and expanding internal cyber defence capability, developing detection use cases and refining monitoring controls within SIEM platforms
- Contributed to incident response playbook development and continuous improvement, documenting investigation workflows and response runbooks
- Supported vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking remediation progress against risk-prioritised findings
- Contributed to identity security programme, supporting Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) access governance and Conditional Access policy implementation
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns, supporting the reduction of human-layer cyber risk across the organisation

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure management within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech environment, supporting security monitoring, endpoint controls and incident response activities
- Contributed to internal security audits, risk assessments and compliance activities, supporting the organisation's cyber defence posture
- Managed endpoint security and network access controls, enforcing consistent security policy compliance across the workforce

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Expanded UAL's internal cyber defence capability by deploying and integrating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender suite, establishing a comprehensive SOC monitoring and incident response function
- Led enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, delivering full endpoint detection and response coverage and significantly improving alert triage efficiency
- Built SOAR-driven automated incident response playbooks that measurably reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-priority security incidents
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, reducing privileged account attack surface and strengthening access controls across critical systems
- Developed a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving threat detection coverage and enabling more accurate and rapid incident triage

- Contributed to achievement and maintenance of Cyber Essentials Plus certification at UAL, demonstrating robust cyber defence baseline controls across the organisation

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000 - 85,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)